Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 18th October 2026

Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 22:15-21)*

In today's gospel, religious leaders try to trap Jesus with a question about paying taxes to Caesar. Pointing to the coin's image and inscription, He teaches us to fulfil our earthly responsibilities while giving our deepest allegiance to God. Jesus reminds us that not every question deserves a fight. What matters is whether our choices reflect goodness, truth, and love, drawing us closer to God,

strengthening our character, and blessing others. A life well lived is measured not by arguments won, but by faithfulness to God's will.

The coin carried Caesar's image, reminding us to respect legitimate laws, perform our duties honestly, support our families, and contribute positively to society. Faith does not excuse us from responsible citizenship; it inspires us to fulfil our duties with sincerity and fairness. The coin bore Caesar's image, but our lives are called to reflect God's goodness. Though we cannot do so perfectly every day, we can choose to grow: let our words encourage, our hands help, and our hearts forgive.

We may give money to the world, time to our responsibilities, and attention to our ambitions, but we must give God what belongs to Him: our love, worship, gratitude, trust, and obedience. Our relationship with God remains the foundation of a meaningful life.

We may carry coins in our pockets, but we carry God's calling in our hearts. Give the world your honest service, others your genuine love, and God your whole heart. That is how an ordinary life becomes a beautiful offering to Him.

Today is World Mission Sunday October has been the month of universal mission since 1926. Mission Sunday invites Catholics to unite with missionaries worldwide and recommit to the Church's missionary activity through prayer, sacrifice and financial support. Funds help young churches and missionaries serve communities in need, both spiritually and materially. Contributions build mission churches, educate seminarians, form catechists and lay leaders, fund children's

health clinics, provide emergency aid in war or disaster, and help missionaries care for refugees. This year's theme is 'One in Christ, united in mission'. Today we celebrate our c. 1,500 Irish-born missionaries and all missionaries worldwide, thanking God for them, for those who support them at home, and for our growing communion with them and the communities they serve. To read

Pope Leo's message for World Mission Sunday, please visit MESSAGE-OF-HIS-HOLINESS-POPE-LEO-XIV-for-WMS-2026.pdf

Requiescat in Pace We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of

Martin Gallagher, Guystown, Ballindrait, Lifford

Anniversaries Jean Allen, Martin Blee, Kathleen Coups, Gerry Crawford, Joseph Dunne, Tommy Dunne, Mary Elliott, Mary Alice Elliott, Annie Feeney, Charles Flanagan, Pat McColgan, Willie McCullagh, Daniel Gerald McFadden, Daniel McGllion, Ryan McGonigle, Bridie O'Donnell, Paddy O'Donnell, Paddy O'Kane, Philomena O'Kane, Pat Quinn, Rose Roulston, Gerry Strawbridge. Rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections

Leckpatrick £1,204.37

Clonleigh €1,969.94

Camus £1,534.14.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 25th October:

1st Reading: Exodus 22:20-26

Psalm: 18:2-3,3-4, 47, 51

2nd Reading: 1 Thessalonians 1:5c-10

Gospel: Matthew 22:34-40

Saints of the Coming Week:

Monday St John de Brebeuf, St Isaac Jogues, priests and companions, martyrs

St Paul of the Cross, priest

Thursday St John Paul II, pope

Friday St John of Capistrano, priest

Saturday St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

St Patrick's Church, Murlog We wish to remind all parishioners that the **Vigil Mass** at St Patrick's, Murlog is now at **6.00 pm**, until further notification. We thank you all for your cooperation and understanding.

Annual Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing takes place on Sunday 15th November in the Silver Birch Hotel, Omagh. Registration at 9.30 am and concluding with celebration of Mass and Healing Service in the afternoon. Guest speaker is Fr John Keane. Theme: 'People of God's Delight' (Ps 149.4). The day is organised by Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group which celebrates its 50th anniversary. All welcome.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses Dates: 29th/30th January, 19th/20th February & 19th/20th March 2027 are now available to book. Please visit www.accordni.com Courses are in person in Everglades Hotel, Derry.

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame, The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, from 2nd – 6th November. This exciting production will showcase the talents of almost 100 local young people, providing a wonderful opportunity for the community to support and celebrate local talent on stage. Audiences can look forward to an energetic and uplifting performance featuring a large cast of dedicated young performers. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via the Class Act Theatre Group website: www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

Global Rosary for Peace in the Tradition of Venerable Patrick Peyton Join hundreds of thousands of Catholics praying for peace on Thursday 22nd October at 3 pm (GMT), the Feast of St John Paul the Great. Visit Pray for peace – HCFM to register and to watch live on Thursday.

Fatima Pilgrimage 2027 led by spiritual director, Fr Sean O'Donnell on 5th July 2027. Cost: £950 pps. £100 off if paid in full by 30/11/26. 7 nights full board in Hotel Cinquentenario. Please contact Patricia 07743936548 / Anne 07784953408.

Book of Memories of Father Paddy O'Kane A new book is being planned about well known Derry priest, Fr Paddy O'Kane, who died in 2022. Due for publication next year, it will include memories and stories from those who knew him, alongside selections from his Derry News column. If you have a memory or story to share, author Ciaran O'Neill would be delighted to hear from you. Email: caoneill1971@gmail.com or phone: 07875 904354.

Coffee Morning – St Patrick's NS, Murlog You are invited to a Coffee Morning in the GP room on Monday 19th October anytime between 10 am and 12 noon. This invitation is open to everyone. Call in, enjoy a cuppa and some home baking. All money raised will go towards school funds.

Pray for Vocations What does God want you to be? If you think you may have a vocation to serve as a priest of the Derry Diocese, please contact your local priest or Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan on 028 79386259 / pgoh2111@gmail.com

The Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on Tuesday 20th October, 3rd November & 1st December from 8 – 9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Abide Women's Conference from 20th – 22nd November at Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, etc. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Cork & Ross diocese. Please visit Abide in His Love at Eventbrite.ie. Registration at https://abide inhislove.eventbrite.com

Donegal Hospice Bethany Bereavement Support Group is a free, confidential listening service. Please tel 0894402787 between 10 am and 9 pm daily.

Legion of Mary New members are needed. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings.

Meeting on Thursday at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please tel Margaret 028 71883159.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend takes place in St Mary's, Knock, Co Mayo from Friday 9th – Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30 pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30 pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

St Columba's Church, Long Tower Solemn Novena of Healing in Honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help and to Celebrate the Jubilee of St Francis of Assisi takes place on the nine Sundays before Christmas, beginning on Sunday 25th October at 6.00 pm, with a guest speaker each week. Everyone welcome.

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7.30pm, starting 20th October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org

St Patrick's National School / Scoil Mhuire gan Smal – Job Vacancy Part-time Caretaker Role (25 hrs per week – shared role between two schools). Seeking a reliable, hardworking and dedicated caretaker to join the friendly school

communities. We are looking for someone who will take pride in ensuring both school sites are safe, secure, clean and well maintained. CVs to be received by post before the closing date of 3 pm on Thursday 22nd October, to either: St Patrick's NS, Murlog, Lifford, Co Donegal F93 AP93, or Lifford NS, Townsparks, Lifford, Co Donegal F93 DE28. For further information please contact the schools.

Flu Vaccination – Walk In will be held in Lifford Health Centre on Monday 19th October from 6 – 8 pm. No appointment needed.

Mass Cards / Mass Bouquets are available from the parish office.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Benone Strand, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm. Some fun, excitement and slight competition. Everyone welcome.

A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett from Fri 6th – Sun 8th November at Termonbacca, an opportunity for prayer, reflection and to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or Termonbacca Derry | Derry | Facebook

NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Newtownstewart,

Centre 2000, 21-27 Moyle Rd, Newtownstewart, BT78 4AP on 30th Oct from 12.30 – 4 pm

& 5 – 7 pm. Visit https://nibts.bookinglive.com/book/add/p/6 / tel 08085534653.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.00 pm**; Sunday: 9.45 am

St Joseph's Glenmornan: Sunday 8.30am (18th Oct – alternate Sundays – 1st Nov)

St Mary's Cloughcor: Sunday 8.30am (25th Oct – alternate Sundays – 8th Nov)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**.**

Office hours: Monday – Thursday 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday 9.30 am – 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. **Republic of Ireland** emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23.